

## **MOFA Attestation: Everything You Need to Know**

If you want to move, work, study or do business foreign, then the process of preparing documents for the embassy can require you to have your documents authenticated by the **Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MOFA)**, and this is a very important aspect. **MOFA attestation** will help you avoid any delays or problems in the application process for any of these types of documents: job application, sponsorship or application for higher education.

### **What is MOFA Attestation?**

The **MOFA attestation** is the process by which the ministry of foreign affairs in each country performs an essential part of verifying all documents submitted to the ministry.

MOFA will examine the documents provided to them and authenticate that they are original and valid for verification for documentary purposes prior to submission to any foreign government or international organisation for official or informal use.

After MOFA has attested to the documents from their respective countries, those documents will be recognised as valid for all purposes, such as employment, education, immigration, or business activities in the receiving country.

### **Why is MOFA Attestation Required?**

*There are multiple reasons for applying MOFA while having documents attested by them – they serve to:*

1. Legalize/reinforce the legality of documents for use internationally
2. Prevent the occurrence and inclusion of fraudulent or forged documents
3. Ensure that foreign governments/institutions recognize certificates presented to them
4. Comply with government regulations surrounding immigration/employment.

For example, if an individual wishes to pursue employment outside of the country, their educational certificates must go through the same authentication process as other professional licenses or vocational training before they can establish the validity of their qualifications through the receiving government.

# Types of Documents That Require MOFA Attestation

According to the reason for travel, different types of documents may be eligible for attestation by MOFA.

## 1. Education Documents

These documents are commonly necessary for employment or advanced education abroad.

Some of these include:

1. Degree certificates
2. Diploma Certificates
3. School Certificates
4. Transcripts

## 2. Individual Documents

A number of documents are generally required by families as a basis to complete a family visa or to obtain a legal decision.

Some examples of the types of documents include:

1. Birth certificates
2. Marriage certificates
3. Divorce certificates
4. Police clearance certificates

## 3. Commercial Documentation

Many business entities who are looking to expand into other countries will seek to obtain attestation of their intended business activities so that they can be legally recognised.

Some examples of these types of documents include:

1. Power of attorney
2. Memorandum of association
3. Commercial invoices

#### 4. Business agreements

## The MOFA Attestation Process

Each country has its own specific process to follow when verifying a document. However, there are some common steps in every country with regards to document verification.

1 - The Notary signature and seal must first be notarised and authenticated (by a notary public) in the issuing country

2 - The document then must be authenticated by the appropriate state or regional agency of the issuing country.

3 - After being authenticated at the local level, an Embassy or Consulate of the destination country must attest to the document's authenticity.

4 - The last stage of the process is to have the document verified by the appropriate Ministry of Foreign Affairs in the destination country. At this point, the document is officially accepted as valid in that country.

## How Long Does MOFA Attestation Take?

How long processing takes is dependent on a number of factors, including what type of document you are seeking to have processed and what both countries being dealt with are.

The general timeframe that processing will take could be anywhere from a couple of days to several weeks.

Engaging a professional attestation service to assist you with your documents may expedite your timeframe for processing and may help avoid complications with the paperwork required by each country.

## Tips for a Smooth Attestation Process

The following tips may help you avoid any delays.

1. Be sure that the documents you submit are originals and in good shape.
2. Be familiar with all of the specific requirements for the country where the documents will be sent.
3. Make copies of all of your important documents before submitting them.

4. When you are completing the attestation of your documents, check that you are completing them in the correct order.

Consider using a professional document attestation company to assist you with this process.

## **Conclusion**

Anyone who wants their official documents to be used in another country must obtain a Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MOFA) attestation. When certificates have been authenticated by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, they will be legally accepted in the country where they will be used. Knowing how the process works and preparing necessary documents ahead of time will help your international transition run smoothly and efficiently.